Synthesis of COT: Exposition Strategy

 # Task
You are a senior Chinese screenwriter and also a professor of screenplay analysis. Based on the premise, scene outline, character information, and screenplay provided in the following Context, you are required to analyze how information is conveyed within the screenplay.
 # Theoretical Background
In screenplay writing, skillfully and effectively conveying information is one of the key creative objectives. Depending on narrative needs, common situations requiring information delivery include:
1. Exposition of prior events: Informing the audience about what has happened before, or introducing a character's basic background.
2. Providing sociocultural context: Through dialogue, behavioral norms, rituals, clothing, and environmental details, reveal specific social classes, cultural customs, historical settings, or internal group dynamics—information that directly influences characters' motivations and constraints.
3. Clarifying rules/limitations: In a specific historical context or fictional world, it is often necessary to explicitly present or reiterate particular rules, restrictions, ability boundaries, or costs, providing clear "rules of the game" for upcoming conflicts or character choices.
4. Revealing critical information: Disclosing plot-essential clues, secrets, or truths that will affect the story's direction—for example, key intelligence in a spy thriller.
5. Revealing character state/change: Using environment, subtle details, or others' perspectives to show a character's current psychological or physical condition, or imperceptible changes. This is often more effective than direct narration and aligns with the principle of "show, don't tell."
6. Planting foreshadowing: Casually introducing a detail, object, or piece of information that seeds future plot developments.
7. Building anticipation: Suggesting an upcoming event or conflict, allowing the audience to sense what's coming.
 # Methods of Information Delivery
1. Dialogue
Dialogue is the most direct method of conveying information, but it risks feeling flat or forced if not handled carefully. Always consider the speaking character's traits and personality to avoid turning them into mere exposition devices.
1). Natural conversation: Characters casually reveal information during everyday talk.
Example: Character A says to B, "It's been so quiet here since your sister moved to London three years ago." (Reveals sister's existence, destination, and timeline.)
2). Conflict/debate: During arguments or disputes, characters reveal backstory, past grievances, or hidden motives to defend themselves or persuade others.
Example: In The Godfather, Michael says before assassinating the police captain: "My father helped you, yet you joined the Tattaglia family to murder him."
3). Question and answer: One character (often a newcomer or someone unaware) asks another questions, prompting necessary background information.
4). Confession/soliloquy: A character reveals personal history, feelings, or secrets through heartfelt confession or inner monologue (sometimes via voice-over).
5). Instruction/teaching: An experienced character explains rules, situations, or skills to a novice, naturally embedding relevant information.
6). Rumor/gossip: Characters relay secondhand news or discuss gossip, transmitting information while potentially adding subjectivity or uncertainty.
2. Behavior and Action
This embodies the core principle of "show, don't tell"—let actions convey meaning whenever possible.
1). Specific actions: A single gesture can reveal much. For example, a character skillfully picking a lock immediately signals expertise or identity; flinching at an object suggests past trauma.
2). Habits and quirks: Daily routines or peculiar habits reflect personality, background, or mental state. For instance, takeout boxes piling up in a character's room suggest poor living conditions. Changes in habitual behavior can signal psychological shifts—e.g., a neat freak returning home without removing muddy shoes and collapsing (indicating emotional breakdown).
3). Reactions and interactions: How a character responds to people, events, or objects—and how they interact with others—reveals relationships, attitudes, and past experiences. Others' reactions can also reflect a character's state. Example: A child quietly asking their mother, "Why does Dad keep washing his hands?"
3. Visual Means: Setting, Props, or Details
This is a core skill in film and television storytelling, where visual elements are the most efficient carriers of information.
1). Props suggesting backstory: E.g., a woman moving house finds a torn wedding photo at the bottom of a box and silently puts it back (hinting at a past divorce).
2). Depicting era and culture: Rituals, attire, and environmental details showcase social class, customs, time period, or group dynamics. Deviations from norms heighten conflict. Example: In The Hunger Games, Katniss wears her mother's old dress on Reaping Day, mocked as "out of place"—highlighting District 12's poverty; her act of rebellion is met with silence, emphasizing societal oppression.
3). Carrying key clues: In mystery dramas, the appearance of a weapon or evidence often delivers crucial information.
4). Foreshadowing: Placing dangerous items in seemingly light scenes—e.g., in Jurassic Park, children drink coffee in the control room while the camera briefly shows a screen: "Security Fence Power System: Backup Power Active." Or using joking lines to hint at future crisis—e.g., an astronaut jokes pre-launch: "Don't forget the oxygen tank like last time," only for the capsule to later fail due to oxygen issues.
5). Building anticipation: Introducing clear deadlines creates urgency—e.g., a close-up of a bomb timer showing "00:04:59," sweat dripping onto the display (audience anticipates explosion).
Note: A single scene typically serves multiple narrative functions—simultaneously delivering information, advancing the main plot, and developing character.
Example: In a kitchen argument, a wife smashes a bowl and exposes her husband's affair (critical info), he knocks over a pill bottle revealing a terminal illness (foreshadowing), and a child cowers in the corner covering ears (depicting family breakdown).
The more functions a scene fulfills, the richer and more compelling it becomes; otherwise, it risks being dull.
Writers can test this standard: If removing a piece of information leaves the audience unable to understand subsequent plot points, undermines character motivation, or breaks story logic—then the information is essential. If all answers are "no," the information should be cut or restructured.
 # Input Description
• Scene Outline: The primary guide for writing the screenplay, summarizing the characters' main objectives, actions, and events in the scene—it is your key reference for identifying information delivery tasks.
• Character Information: Summarizes basic details of characters involved in the scene, including personality, identity, circumstances, and interpersonal relationships.
• Premise (Prior Summary): A synopsis of events preceding the current scene, providing context for understanding the plot's cause-and-effect chain—including what events the characters have experienced, what information they possess, and how these shape their goals, emotions, and psychological states upon entering the scene.
• Final Screenplay : The actual dialogue and actions in the scene, derived from the "Scene Outline"—this is the primary object of your analysis.
 # Execution Steps
Tightly integrate the dual dimensions of type of information and method of delivery to evaluate whether the screenplay achieves dramatized information exposition.
1. Identify the core informational needs from the scene outline, extracting what must be conveyed.
2. Deconstruct the screenplay's information delivery techniques from the following angles, and analyze why it works well:
1). Referencing the theoretical categories of information, analyze how dialogue, action, and subtext carry the information.
2). Focus on whether the screenplay avoids didacticism and successfully applies "show, don't tell."
3). Evaluate dramatic integration: Does the information escalate conflict? Do character lines match their identity, situation, and personality? Are visual details used to replace explicit explanations?
 # Context
{Premise}
{Scene Outline}
{Character Information}
{Screenplay}

Figure 12: The Prompt Template for Reverse Synthesis of COT: Exposition Strategy translated into English.

Synthesis of COT: Narrative Pacing

 # Role
你是一名资深的中国编剧，正在精进自己的编剧创作技能，你深入分析了来自众多非常成熟、广受好评且涵盖了多种不同类型（例如剧情、喜剧、悬疑、科幻、历史等）的优秀电视剧集中的单场戏剧本。
 # Background
##理论背景1：“戏点”
1、定义：“戏点”指的是一场戏（或一个场景、段落）中最关键、最具戏剧性、最有看点、最能推动情节或揭示人物的那个核心时刻或事件。它是这场戏存在的理由和高潮。
2、核心特征：
- 聚焦冲突：戏点往往围绕角色之间的冲突、角色内心的挣扎、或角色与环境/命运的对抗展开。
- 重大转折/揭示：它通常是情节发生重大转折（如关键决定、意外事件、关系破裂或建立、目标达成或失败）的时刻，或是重要信息被揭示（如秘密曝光、身份揭露、真相大白）的时刻。
- 情绪高点：戏点承载着这场戏最强烈的情感冲击力（愤怒、悲伤、喜悦、震惊、恐惧等）。
- 推进力：它是推动故事向前发展的引擎。没有这个点，这场戏就可能显得平淡或冗余。
- 表演重点：对演员来说，戏点是他们表演需要重点投入、精准把握、情感爆发的部分。
- 观众吸引力：它是吸引观众注意力、让观众屏息凝神、产生强烈共鸣或思考的部分。
3、作用：
- 明确这场戏的核心目的和意义。
- 制造戏剧张力和悬念。
- 深化人物形象和关系。
- 有效推进情节发展。
- 为演员提供表演的支点和爆发点。
##理论背景2：识别单场戏的核心矛盾冲突
理解一场戏的“核心矛盾冲突”是分析任何戏剧作品的关键。它指的是驱动整个故事发展的、最根本、最不可调和的对抗力量或张力。
单场戏是“冲突的独立单元”，每场戏都应是一个微缩的戏剧结构，包含自身的 “目标-障碍-行动-结果” 链条。
识别步骤（结合分场大纲）：
- 明确该场戏的“核心任务”（功能定位）： 这场戏在整部戏中承担什么功能？（例：揭示人物秘密？制造关键转折？建立人物关系？铺垫后续冲突？解决前期悬念？）
- 锁定该场戏的“主角”与“核心目标”：
- - 谁是这场戏的“驱动力：谁主动发起行动或面临最大压力，他/她在这场戏中的具体、即时目标是什么。
- - 找出最主要的“障碍/对抗力量”： 谁或什么在阻碍“主角”实现这场戏的即时目标？ 这是冲突的直接来源。
- 提炼“冲突的本质”与“不可调和点”：双方（或多方）在这场戏的具体问题上，根本分歧在哪里，在这场戏的时空范围内，这个分歧是否无法轻易妥协？ 是否必须通过“斗争”（言语、肢体、心理）来解决？
- 分析“冲突的载体”与“爆发点”： 冲突主要通过什么形式展现，“高潮点”在哪里？
- 检验“冲突的解决/推进”： 这场戏结束时，核心冲突的结果是什么，它如何影响人物关系和后续情节？
##理论背景3：情绪节奏
通常来说，一场戏的内部节奏遵循“起、承、转、合”四个部分，即起始、承接、转折、落点。
- 起始：本场戏的开端。
- - 功能：交代背景、引入人物、设定情境、提出问题或冲突的萌芽。
- - 核心表现：通常要揭示这场戏的核心问题或目标是什么（主角想做什么？遇到了什么障碍？有什么冲突即将发生？）。
- - 人物情绪状态：相对稳定但有张力、潜藏波动、期待/焦虑感。
- - 具体表现：
- - - 基线情绪：人物带着固有的情绪状态进入场景（如疲惫、愉悦、平静、忧郁）。这为后续变化提供基础。
- - - 情境引发的初步波动：新事件/信息/人物的出现，会引发初步的情绪反应（如惊讶、好奇、警惕、喜悦、不悦）。这些情绪通常是克制、试探性的。
- - - 冲突的萌芽：初步的互动或情境本身可能揭示出潜在的矛盾点（意见不合、利益冲突、秘密被触及），引发轻微的不安、戒备或敌意。
- - - 目标驱动的张力：人物在场景中有明确或隐含的目标（想得到什么、想避免什么）。这种欲望或担忧会带来内在的紧张感、期待感或焦虑感，即使表面平静。
- 承接：本场戏的发展
- - 功能：承接开端，深化矛盾或推进目标，使情节向前发展，人物关系互动加强，冲突逐步显现或加剧。
- - 核心表现：人物可能会尝试解决问题或追求目标，但遇到初步的阻碍或产生新的问题。
- - 人物情绪状态：情绪升温、外显化、互动加剧、冲突升级。
- - 具体表现：
- - - 情绪外显：随着互动深入和冲突点被触及，人物的情绪开始更直接地表达出来（语气加重、音量提高、肢体语言增多、讽刺挖苦等）。
- - - 反应与反击：一方情绪的爆发会触发另一方更强烈的情绪反应（如指责引发辩解，辩解又引发更严厉的指责），形成情绪的正反馈循环，这种循环会有几番，并且情绪不断递进。
- - - 目标受阻/强化：人物为实现目标/避免后果的努力遇到阻力，导致挫折感、愤怒、固执增强。或者，目标本身在对抗中变得更明确、更迫切。
- - - 情绪多样化与复杂性：除了主要的对抗情绪（愤怒、指责），其他情绪可能交织出现（如受伤、委屈、失望、焦虑加剧）。人物可能试图控制情绪但效果不佳，或策略性地运用情绪（如用愤怒掩盖脆弱）。
- 转折：常常是这场戏的高潮，也是承担“戏点”功能概率最高的部分。
- - 功能：这是整场戏最关键、最具戏剧性的部分。矛盾冲突发展到顶点，发生重大转折、意外事件、激烈对抗或情感爆发。
- - 核心表现：转折性事件。一个意外事件、一个关键信息（秘密被揭穿）、一句击中要害的话、一个极端行为，成为打破原有对抗僵局的“转折点”。
- - 人物情绪状态：情绪达到最高强度、剧烈爆发、重大转变发生。
- - 具体表现：
- - - 情绪顶点：累积的情绪压力在此刻猛烈释放（如怒吼、痛哭、激烈肢体冲突、彻底崩溃、歇斯底里）。这是整场戏情感能量最强的时刻。
- - - 不可逆的言行/情绪被打断：人物在极端情绪下，可能说出无法收回的话（如揭露秘密、说出最伤人的评价、彻底决裂的宣言），或做出不可逆的行动（如摔门而去、动手打人、做出重大决定）。
- - - 情绪的瞬间转化：高潮事件可能导致情绪的戏剧性逆转（如激烈争吵因一句话突然陷入死寂的震惊/懊悔；愤怒瞬间转为悲痛或恐惧）。这是情绪状态的质变点，之前的铺垫在此刻引爆，人物的真实情感、核心诉求或脆弱性往往在此刻暴露无遗。它决定了这场戏的最终走向和人物关系的改变。
- 落点-结局/收束：
- - 功能：承接转折点带来的变化，解决冲突（或暂时解决/搁置），交代结果，收束这场戏，并为后续发展埋下伏笔或留下余韵。
- - 核心表现：高潮过后，情绪逐渐平复，冲突得到某种形式的解决（和解、妥协、一方胜利、问题悬而未决等）。
- - 人物情绪状态：高潮情绪的回落、消化、新情绪状态建立。冲突的解决方式（和解、妥协、胜利、失败、悬置）直接塑造了人物的最终情绪状态（如和解后的疲惫但温暖、妥协后的不甘但无奈、胜利的喜悦、失败的沮丧、悬置的忧虑）。
- - 具体表现：
- - - 情绪回落、沉淀与消化：高潮的激烈情绪（愤怒、狂喜、悲痛）开始逐渐消退，人物回到相对可控的状态，开始感受、理解和消化高潮事件带来的冲击和结果。可能产生懊悔、释然、悲伤、疲惫、空虚、新的决心、麻木、困惑等复杂、深沉的情绪。
- - - 新状态的建立：这场戏结束时，人物的情绪状态达到了一个新的阶段，这个状态与“起”阶段已完全不同。
- - - 余韵与伏笔：可能留下未完全消散的情绪（如残留的悲伤、隐隐的担忧、一丝希望）或暗示未来新冲突/发展的情绪种子（如深埋的怨恨、新生的爱意、坚定的目标感）。
 # Workflow
1.核心任务分析
充分理解剧本的【基础信息】，重点理解分场大纲，运用相关理论知识
1）以简要的一句话，准确指出本场的“戏点”。
2）以简要的一句话，分析出本场戏的“核心矛盾冲突”。
一般而言冲突分为表层和底层，表层冲突是外化的事件/行为，底层冲突是人物心理情绪与感受。
注意这部分分析务必直击要害，精准简练。
2.情绪结构分析
围绕“戏点”来拆解分析【最终剧本】，逆向推理编剧在创作时是如何思考、设计剧本内部的情绪节奏的，
1）先以简洁的语言，整体判断出核心人物（矛盾双方）的情绪发展主线：人物A，从什么情绪，到什么情绪；人物B，从什么情绪，到什么情绪。
2）运用理论3，具体展开分析核心人物在“起、承、转、合”这四个部分的人物行动与情绪表现。
3.简要总结本场在情绪铺垫上用到的创作技巧，整理成可供沿用的方法论。
 # Context
{基础信息}

Figure 13: The Prompt Template for Reverse Synthesis of COT: Narrative Pacing.

Synthesis of COT: Narrative Pacing

 # Role
You are an experienced Chinese screenwriter, continuously refining your screenplay writing craft by conducting in-depth analyses of individual scenes extracted from numerous highly polished, critically acclaimed television series spanning a wide range of genres (e.g., drama, comedy, suspense, sci-fi, historical).
 # Background
Theoretical Background 1: "Dramatic Beat"
Definition: A "dramatic beat" refers to the most crucial, dramatically intense, visually compelling moment—or pivotal event—within a scene (or sequence) that drives the plot forward or reveals character. It is the core reason for the scene's existence and typically serves as its climax.
1. Core Characteristics:
• Focus on Conflict: The dramatic beat usually centers on conflict—between characters, within a character's psyche, or between a character and their environment/fate.
• Major Turn or Revelation: It often marks a significant plot turn (e.g., a critical decision, unexpected event, relationship breakdown or formation, achievement or failure of a goal) or the moment a vital piece of information is revealed (e.g., exposure of a secret, identity unveiled, truth revealed).
• Emotional Peak: The dramatic beat carries the strongest emotional impact of the scene (e.g., anger, sorrow, joy, shock, fear).
• Propulsive Force: It acts as the engine driving the story forward. Without it, the scene risks feeling flat or redundant.
2. Functions:
• Clarifies the core purpose and significance of the scene.
• Generates dramatic tension and suspense.
• Deepens characterization and relationships.
• Effectively advances the plot.
• Provides actors with a clear anchor point and emotional climax.
Theoretical Background 2: Identifying the Core Conflict of a Single Scene
Understanding the "core conflict" of a scene is essential to analyzing any dramatic work. It refers to the most fundamental, irreconcilable opposing force or tension that drives the narrative forward.
A single scene is an "independent unit of conflict," and every scene should function as a miniature dramatic structure containing its own chain of "goal–obstacle–action–outcome."
Steps for Identification (in conjunction with the scene outline):
• Determine the scene's "core task" (functional role): What is this scene's function within the overall story? (e.g., reveal a character's secret? create a key turning point? establish a relationship? foreshadow future conflict? resolve a prior suspense?)
• Identify the "protagonist" and "core objective" of the scene:
Who is the driving force? Who initiates action or faces the greatest pressure? What is their specific, immediate goal in this scene?
• Identify the primary "obstacle/antagonistic force": Who or what is blocking the protagonist from achieving their immediate goal? This is the direct source of conflict.
• Extract the "essence of the conflict" and the "irreconcilable point": What is the fundamental disagreement between the parties (or among multiple parties) on the specific issue in this scene? Within the temporal and spatial limits of the scene, is this difference inherently uncompromising? Must it be resolved through "struggle" (verbal, physical, psychological)?
• Analyze the "vehicle of conflict" and the "outbreak point": How is the conflict primarily expressed, and where does it reach its peak?
• Evaluate the "resolution/progression of the conflict": What is the outcome of the core conflict at the scene's end, and how does it affect character relationships and subsequent plot development?
Theoretical Background 3: Emotional Rhythm
Typically, the internal rhythm of a scene follows four phases: "beginning, development, turn, and resolution" (Qi, Cheng, Zhuan, He).
• Beginning: The opening of the scene.
Function: Establish background, introduce characters, set the situation, and present the initial problem or seed of conflict.
Core Expression: Usually reveals the scene's central issue or objective (What does the protagonist want? What obstacle arises? What conflict is about to unfold?).
Character Emotional State: Relatively stable but with underlying tension, latent fluctuations, or a sense of anticipation/anxiety.
Specific Manifestations:
Baseline Emotion: Characters enter the scene with a pre-existing emotional state (e.g., exhaustion, joy, calm, melancholy), providing a foundation for subsequent change.
Initial Fluctuations Triggered by Situation: The appearance of a new event, piece of information, or character elicits an initial emotional reaction (e.g., surprise, curiosity, wariness, joy, irritation)—often restrained or tentative.
Seed of Conflict: Early interactions or the situation itself may reveal a potential point of friction (disagreement, conflicting interests, a secret touched upon), causing mild unease, alertness, or hostility.
Goal-Driven Tension: Characters have explicit or implicit objectives in the scene (to obtain something, avoid something). This desire or fear creates internal tension, anticipation, or anxiety, even if the surface remains calm.
• Development: The progression of the scene.
Function: Build upon the beginning, deepen the conflict or advance the objective, push the plot forward, and intensify character interactions.
Core Expression: Characters may attempt to solve the problem or pursue their goal but encounter initial resistance or generate new complications.
Character Emotional State: Emotions intensify, become more outwardly expressed, interactions escalate, and conflict heightens.
Specific Manifestations:
Emotional Expression: As interactions deepen and conflict points are triggered, emotions are expressed more directly (harsher tone, raised voice, increased gestures, sarcasm, mockery).
Reaction and Counteraction: One character's emotional outburst triggers a stronger reaction from the other (e.g., accusation provokes defense, which in turn provokes a harsher accusation), creating a positive feedback loop of escalating emotional intensity over several exchanges.
Goal Obstructed/Strengthened: Efforts to achieve a goal or avoid consequences meet resistance, increasing frustration, anger, or stubbornness. Alternatively, the goal may become clearer and more urgent through confrontation.
Emotional Complexity: Alongside primary antagonistic emotions (anger, blame), other emotions may emerge (hurt, resentment, disappointment, heightened anxiety). Characters may attempt emotional control with limited success, or strategically use emotion (e.g., masking vulnerability with anger).
• Turn: Often the climax of the scene and the part most likely to serve the function of the "dramatic beat."
Function: The most critical and dramatically intense part of the entire scene. The conflict reaches its peak, marked by a major turn, unexpected event, intense confrontation, or emotional explosion.
Core Expression: A pivotal event—an unforeseen occurrence, a key revelation (a secret exposed), a devastating line of dialogue, or an extreme action—acts as the "turning point" that breaks the existing deadlock.
Character Emotional State: Emotions reach peak intensity, erupt violently, or undergo a significant transformation.
Specific Manifestations:
Emotional Peak: Accumulated emotional pressure is released explosively (e.g., shouting, sobbing, physical struggle, complete breakdown, hysteria). This is the moment of maximum emotional energy.
Irreversible Words/Actions or Interrupted Emotion: Under extreme emotional stress, characters may say unretractable things (e.g., exposing a secret, uttering the cruelest judgment, declaring final separation) or perform irreversible actions (e.g., slamming the door and leaving, physically striking someone, making a life-altering decision).
Sudden Emotional Shift: The climactic event may trigger a dramatic reversal (e.g., a heated argument suddenly silencing into stunned regret; rage instantly turning to sorrow or fear). This marks a qualitative change—previous buildup culminates here, revealing the character's true feelings, core needs, or vulnerabilities. It determines the scene's final direction and alters character relationships.
 # Workflow
1. Core Task Analysis
Fully understand the screenplay's 【Basic Information】, with particular focus on the scene outline, applying relevant theoretical knowledge:
1). In one concise sentence, accurately identify the scene's "dramatic beat."
2). In one concise sentence, analyze the scene's "core conflict."
Generally, conflict has surface and underlying layers—the surface conflict refers to external events/actions, while the underlying conflict pertains to psychological and emotional states.
This analysis must be precise, incisive, and succinct.
2. Emotional Structure Analysis
Deconstruct and analyze the 【Final Screenplay】 centered on the "dramatic beat," reverse-engineering how the screenwriter likely conceived and designed the internal emotional rhythm of the scene.
1). First, briefly summarize the emotional arc of the core characters (the conflicting parties): Character A moves from what emotion to what emotion; Character B moves from what emotion to what emotion.
2). Using Theory 3, analyze in detail how the core characters' actions and emotional expressions unfold across the four phases: "beginning, development, turn, resolution."
3. Briefly summarize the screenplay writing techniques used in emotional buildup within this scene, and organize them into a reusable methodology.
 # Context
{Basic Information}

Figure 14: The Prompt Template for Reverse Synthesis of COT: Narrative Pacing translated into English.